

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 51349.92 ▼ 131.59 0.26%

NASDAQ 26797.54 ▼ 0.1%

STOXX 600 638.08 ▼ 0.1%

10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 4/32, yield 5.256%

OIL \$89.38 ▼ \$3.22

GOLD \$4,147.70 ▲ \$11.30

EURO \$1.1343

YEN 157.29

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Market choppiness** and artificial intelligence safety fears are spooking investors and throwing into disarray what was expected to be a string of blockbuster IPOs this fall. **A1**

◆ **The punishing selloff** in Treasuries continued, and major U.S. stock indexes fell, with the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq shedding 0.2%, 0.3% and 0.1%, respectively. **B13**

◆ **Investment bank** Piper Sandler has been in talks to combine with advisory firm Perella Weinberg, discussing a pact that would join two firms known for their dealmaking. **B13**

◆ **AT&T signed** a \$3 billion deal with Corning, which will supply the mobile carrier with the fiber and cable needed to expand its network. **B4**

◆ **The Treasury** will automatically enroll tens of millions of children in the government's new Trump Accounts. **A2**

◆ **New York Fed President** John Williams suggested that policymakers could wait until December before raising interest rates again. **A2**

◆ **U.S. home-price growth** ticked up again in July, though trends differed across regions while inflation cooled. **A2**

◆ **Cruise line Carnival** reported higher profit and revenue for the third quarter as demand held up even as oil prices remain elevated. **B2**

◆ **Alaska Air** is installing a new premium economy section on some planes and is enhancing its international business-class amenities. **B3**

◆ **Paramount picked** HBO's content chief to oversee streaming operations once the Warner merger is final. **B4**

Worldwide

◆ **Americans in both parties** back government-imposed price caps and other market interventions to make life more affordable, suggesting new support for populist ideas once associated with the margins. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** used federal funds from the Department of Homeland Security to finance a set of controversial pro-Trump advertisements that recently began airing on television. **A6**

◆ **Defense Secretary** Pete Hegseth plans to announce plans to cut by 20% the number of positions reserved for generals and admirals. **A3**

◆ **The Trump administration** built an AI-powered tool that the developers say will act as a "concierge" to federal government information and services. **A3**

◆ **The Navy chose** Boeing to build its next-generation fighter, the latest contract win for the company. **A6**

◆ **Mayor Zohran Mamdani**, whose anti-Israel rhetoric has been a polarizing force in Jewish communities, presented a plan for combating a rise in antisemitism in New York City. **A3**

◆ **Mamdani must redo** the rollout of his new pied-à-terre tax, a state judge ruled, dealing a major blow to one of the mayor's signature policies. **A3**

◆ **Over 100 settlers** overwhelmed Israeli security forces who were trying to escort a Palestinian family back to their home in the West Bank. **A7**

◆ **Explosives that** injured three South Korean troops last week in the DMZ were likely North Korean land mines, Seoul officials said. **A8**

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Trump Tells AI Leaders Regulation Isn't on Menu



KENT NISHIMURA/GETTY IMAGES

NO WORRIES: President Trump hosted tech chiefs—including Mark Zuckerberg, Jensen Huang, Elon Musk, Sundar Pichai, Dario Amodei and Jeff Bezos—Tuesday at a White House lunch and said AI shouldn't be stifled by regulation, despite industry fears. **A4**

Americans Warm to Populism As Life Gets More Expensive

People in both parties want government action to cut prices, WSJ survey shows

By Aaron Zitner

U.S. voters in both parties back government-imposed price caps and other market interventions to make life more affordable, suggesting new support for populist ideas that were once largely outside the political mainstream.

That is the takeaway of a new Wall Street Journal survey that asked respondents what they want from their elected officials and the political system. Voters of all partisan stripes strongly support capping the cost of prescription drugs, child care and credit card interest rates.

The survey suggests that a coalition reaching beyond the nation's familiar party labels exists for a range of policies at a time when voters view Republicans and Democrats negatively. Large majorities, for

example, support both strong border security and a pathway to citizenship for many people in the country illegally, the poll finds. A near-majority of Democrats agrees with Republicans and independent voters that people should show a photo ID when balloting to ensure that only citizens vote.

The survey tested more than 30 policy ideas that are part of the midterm campaign discussion or congressional debate, many of them focused on the cost of living. Nearly three-quarters of voters sup-

port a cap on child-care costs for working families, an idea backed by liberal Democrats, such as Sen. Elizabeth Warren of Massachusetts. Nearly three-quarters support the idea of a government website to guide consumers to discounted drugs, which President Trump put into practice with his "Trump Rx" site.

And nearly four in five voters support capping credit card interest rates at 10%. That has drawn bipartisan support in Congress, with pro-

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Gap Between Rich and Super Rich Widens

The ultrawealthy aren't just pulling away from average Americans. Buoyed by a stock-market boom that has added trillions of dollars to their net worth, now the extremely rich are even pulling away from other rich Americans.

By Rachel Louise Ensing, Justin Lahart and Peter Santilli

The top 0.1% wealthiest Americans have seen their total wealth more than double since the end of 2019, according to new data from the Federal Reserve.

The year the pandemic started was when the ultrawealthy began to pull away from other rich groups, according to a Wall Street Journal analysis of Fed data.

In dollar terms, the very richest Americans have gained a total \$14.5 trillion in wealth over that period, with most of that—about \$10 trillion—coming from gains in stocks and mutual funds, according to the Fed data, which run through the end of June.

The 0.1% now control about \$28 trillion, or about 15% of the nation's total wealth, which amounts to nearly \$186

trillion. The average wealth for a household in this group is over \$200 million.

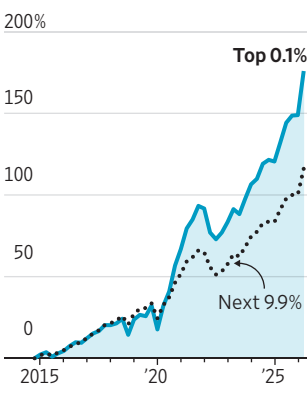
As of 2022 you had to have at least \$45.8 million to be in the top 0.1%, according to the most detailed data available from the Fed. With wealth among the group up by about 50% since then, that threshold is much higher now.

The people who fall into this group aren't usually traditional salaried workers.

Rather, they are much more likely to be the owner of a bunch of car dealerships or an heir living off invest-

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Cumulative change in net worth since the end of 2014



Source: Federal Reserve

Investor Jitters Throw IPOs Into Disarray

Ring maker Oura postpones listing as timing shifts for Anthropic, others

By Corrie Driebusch

Market choppiness and artificial-intelligence safety fears are spooking investors and throwing into disarray what was expected to be a string of blockbuster initial public offerings this fall.

Smart-ring maker Oura was the latest company to postpone its initial public offering, when it said on Tuesday that it was delaying it due to "uncertainty in the IPO market."

The company, which was aiming to raise up to \$2.2 billion in a listing that valued it at around \$15.6 billion, changed its plans after potential investors made clear they saw the valuation as too high, people familiar with the matter said. Investors questioned whether its revenue growth would take a hit as consumers feel the pinch of higher prices and interest rates.

Investors had been lining up for a parade of IPOs this fall that was expected to be headlined by a gigantic and record-setting offering from Anthropic. But volatility in oil prices and spiking bond yields, as well as an intensifying debate around AI safety, dented investor enthusiasm and prompted many of the companies to revisit listing plans.

SoftBank-backed data center company SB Energy delayed its IPO date after getting pushback on its potential valuation, according to people close to the deal. Many on Wall Street expected Nvidia-backed cloud startup NScale to launch its roadshow pitch to investors as early as next week, but some now anticipate the timing could change, other people familiar with the matter said.

Nuclear-reactor company Holtec withdrew its IPO filing earlier this month, citing unfavorable market conditions.

Dunkin' owner Inspire Brands originally eyed a late 2026 or early 2027 IPO, other people familiar with the matter said. But it is now unlikely to go public this year unless shares in publicly traded restaurant rivals begin to trade

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Car Market Pinched by 'Total Stall' In Making New Models

By Sharon Terlep

Something is missing from the nation's auto showrooms: new car models.

"It's real bad," said Michael DiFeo, a New Jersey Cadillac dealer. "I literally have people saying, 'I am not leasing this car again. It's the same car and the price keeps going up.'"

Fresh models attract car buyers to showrooms and command higher prices. Without them, dealers are left pushing aging designs while automakers race to churn out new models—meanwhile using throwbacks, special editions and six-figure status symbols to keep buyers coming.

Fewer new models are hitting the market than at any time in recent history. Automakers are expected to redesign 9% of their lineup on average across the 2026 through 2028 model years—well below the 20-year average of 14%,

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INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL

The 20-something employees who want feedback to be gentle. **A10**



BUSINESS & FINANCE

He was rejected by Goldman out of college. Now John Waldron is set to run the bank. **B1**

If I'm Such a Helicopter Parent, Why's My Kid Playing in Trash?

* * *

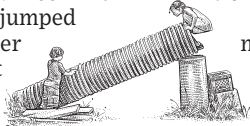
Families flex their free-range bona fides by letting their children loose in a junkyard

By Rachel Louise Ensing

GOVERNORS ISLAND, N.Y.—When Amy Potter was growing up, she roamed free in rural Australia and jumped off a shed onto her trampoline until it had a hole in it. To give her 8-year-old daughter

Sigrid a similar experience, she pays for her to visit a junkyard playground on this former Coast Guard installation in New York City.

At The Yard, elementary school children play with hammers, saws and knives. They climb



Hazard play

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Quest to Make Monopoly in U.S. Struggled to Pass Go

Game company ran into high costs, cracked trays and a dice dilemma

By Ruth Simon

Jonathan Silva and his team at WS Game Company set a challenge for themselves last year: Produce a bespoke Monopoly game that was 100% made in America.

The company set out to produce its first U.S.-made game after President Trump imposed high tariffs on Chinese imports. The goal was to have it ready in February, ahead of the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence.

"It was a colossal headache. I hope I don't have to go through it again," said Silva, who at one point considered canceling the whole project. "It was not profitable for our company in any shape or form."

What Silva and his team discovered was that options for manufacturing a game in the U.S. are extremely limited

and costs can be prohibitively high. A like-for-like game made in China would have been better quality, cost less and come to market faster. Still, the company persevered—although it ended up just shy of 100% American-made.

Silva's company produces high-end versions of classic games, from Chess & Checkers to The Game of Life. For 25 years, all of the games had been made in China. His father, the company's co-founder, would spend weeks at a time in Asia. The company has developed deep relationships with the company's Chinese factories and produced games for the likes of Restoration Hardware and Pottery Barn, as well as mass-market retailers.

Silva, co-owner and chief executive of the family-run company, landed on the idea

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